

Buyer & Seller Visibility Rules

Document ID: MS-DEAL-002 **Department:** Marketplace Trust & Safety **Subject:** Anonymity, Visibility, and Negotiation Workflows

1. Purpose & Core Philosophy

This document outlines the strict visibility permissions and anonymity rules enforced on the Mediashippers platform. The system is designed to prevent platform bypass (off-platform deals), ensure unbiased content evaluation, and protect the privacy of both buyers and sellers during the initial deal discovery phase.

Visibility states are strictly divided into two phases: **Pre-Shortlist** (Discovery Phase) and **Post-Shortlist** (Negotiation Phase).

2. Pre-Shortlist: Buyer Anonymity Rules (Discovery Phase)

During the initial discovery phase, buyer identities remain strictly hidden. This ensures sellers submit content based purely on the deal's requirements rather than the buyer's corporate identity or perceived budget.

What Sellers CAN view (Deal Parameters):

- **Platform Name:** The intended distribution platform (e.g., "GlobalStream Pro").
- **Regions:** Specific geographic inclusion and exclusion territories.
- **Requested Rights:** Required usage permissions (e.g., SVOD, AVOD, TV Rights).
- **Languages & Genres:** The exact linguistic and thematic requirements.
- **Payment Structure:** The proposed financial model (e.g., Flat Fee, Revenue Share).
- **License Term:** The duration of the requested license (e.g., 3 Years, 5 Years).

What Sellers CANNOT view (PII & Corporate Identity):

- **Buyer Company Name:** The legal corporate entity behind the deal.
- **Buyer Contact Information:** Direct phone numbers or physical addresses.
- **Buyer Representative Details:** Names or titles of the acquisition executives.
- **Buyer Email Address:** Corporate or personal email addresses.

3. Pre-Shortlist: Seller Submission Visibility (Evaluation Phase)

When a seller submits a title to an active deal, the buyer receives a dashboard view of the submission. To prevent buyers from bypassing the platform, seller contact details remain locked until the buyer commits to a negotiation.

What Buyers CAN review (Content Assessment):

- **Title Names:** The primary name of the submitted film, series, or asset.
- **Content Metadata:** Supplementary details such as cast, director, synopsis, release year, and runtime.
- **Rights Availability:** Confirmation of the rights the seller actually holds.
- **Territory Clearances:** Geographic regions where the content is legally clear to license.
- **Existing Dubs/Subtitles:** Available localized audio tracks and text files.
- **Content Categories:** Classification (e.g., Documentary, TV Series).

What Buyers CANNOT view:

- **Seller Contact Details:** Names, emails, phone numbers, or corporate addresses of the distributor/seller.

4. The Shortlisting Workflow (Transition Phase)

The shortlisting event is the critical trigger that transitions a deal from "Discovery" to "Negotiation." By shortlisting a title, the buyer indicates serious intent, which unlocks visibility features for both parties.

The Sequential Shortlist Trigger:

1. **Action:** Buyer clicks "Shortlist" on a specific submitted title.
2. **Notification:** An automated platform alert is instantly sent to the seller indicating interest.
3. **Identity Reveal:** The mutual veil of anonymity is lifted. The buyer sees the seller's corporate identity, and the seller sees the buyer's corporate identity.
4. **Chat Unlocked:** The secure internal messaging system is activated between the specific buyer and seller.
5. **Status Change:** The submission status updates from "Submitted" to "Shortlisted."

5. Post-Shortlist: Chat Access & Negotiation Rules

The chat interface is the platform's dedicated environment for finalizing licensing agreements.

- **Default State (Disabled):** Chat is completely disabled and inaccessible until the buyer explicitly shortlists at least one submitted title from that specific seller.
- **Active State (Enabled):** Once chat is enabled, both parties enter the formal negotiation stage. During this phase, initial requirements are considered fluid, and the following parameters can be mutually revised:
 - **Payment Structure Renegotiation:** Moving from a Flat Fee to a Minimum Guarantee (MG) + Rev Share, or adjusting the overall price.
 - **Territory Adjustments:** Adding or removing specific countries based on the seller's actual availability.
 - **Rights Scope Modification:** Upgrading from Non-Exclusive to Exclusive rights, or adding/removing dubbing permissions.

6. Confidentiality & Audit Rules

Trust is paramount to the Mediashippers marketplace. All communication is protected under strict confidentiality protocols.

- **Strict Confidentiality:** All chat messages, negotiated terms, and shared files on the platform are considered strictly confidential between the specific buyer and seller.
- **Admin Blindness:** Under normal operating circumstances, marketplace administrators cannot read, intercept, or monitor active chat negotiations.
- **Exception Workflows (Audits):** Platform administrators possess the technical capability to override privacy settings and audit conversations **only** under the following strict trigger conditions:
 - **Formal Disputes:** When either party reports a breach of contract or platform terms.
 - **Fraud Investigations:** If automated systems flag suspicious links, payment bypassing attempts, or irregular account behavior.
 - **Policy Violations:** Instances involving the sharing of illegal content, harassment, or explicit violation of Mediashippers Marketplace rules.